

Unit 2



What do you like?

Inglés Profesional





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Introduction

In this unit you will learn firstly the main verbs and expressions to express your **likes and dislikes**. After that, you will study how to express existence with the structure **there is / there are**. Then, you will learn how to use the indefinite articles **a / an** and the determiners **some / any**.

Next, we will practice how to make questions with the **Wh pronouns**. In the next point you will learn the difference between **pronouns and possessive forms**. Then, you will practice the **prepositions of time**.

Finally, we will learn some **connectors** and examples of how to use them in a sentence that will help you improve your conversation in English.

These key skills should be reviewed before progressing with your professional English studies.



2.1.

Likes and dislikes verbs

2.1.1. How to express your preferences

There are many ways to express likes and dislikes (love, adore, enjoy, hate dislike, can't stand...). Let's see the main verbs in this table.

Level	English verb	Example
😊 Me encanta	Love	I love pizza.
😄 Me gusta mucho	Really like	I really like dancing.
😊 Me gusta	Like	I like reading
😐 No me importa	Don't mind	I don't mind walking.
😐 No me gusta	Dislike / Don't like	I don't like spicy food
😡 Odio / Detesto	Hate	I hate waking up early
😡 No soporto	Can't stand	I can't stand smoking.

As you can see in the examples, these verbs must be followed by a noun or a verb. If we are talking about a verb, this must be followed by a gerund or by a "to-infinitive", although the gerund is the most natural option. Look at the following examples:

- > "I love cars" ✓
- > "I love driving cars" ✓
- > "I love to drive cars" ✓
- > "I love drive cars" ✗



RECUERDA

Estos verbos pueden ir seguidos de un sustantivo o sintagma nominal, así como de un verbo. En el caso de ir seguido de un verbo recuerda que éste tiene que ir en su forma de gerundio (-ing) o precedido de "to"





2.2.

Expressing existence

2.2.1. There is / There are

"There is" and "There are" are used to say that something exists or is present in a place.

> "There is" →

Used with **singular nouns** and **uncountable things**.

- » There is a book on the table. (One book) → Hay un libro en la mesa
- » There is some water in the glass. (Uncountable) → Hay agua en el vaso

> "There are" →

Used with **plural nouns**.

- » There are two cats in the garden. (More than one) → Hay dos gatos en el jardín.
- » There are many cars in the street. (Plural) → Hay muchos coches en la calle.

💡 RECUERDA

- + Utiliza "there is" para sustantivos en singular o que sean incontables.
- + Utiliza "there are" para sustantivos en plural.

2.2.2. Indefinite articles a / an

They are used with singular countable nouns when referring to something non-specific.

> "A" → Before words that start with a consonant sound.

- » A dog, a house, a university → un perro, una casa, una universidad

> "An" → Before words that start with a vowel sound.

- » An apple, an hour, an elephant → una manzana, una hora, un elefante





2.2.3. Quantifiers some / any

They are determiners used to refer to an indefinite or unspecified quantity of something. The key to using them correctly lies in the context of the sentence—whether it is affirmative, negative, or interrogative—and in the nuance one wants to convey in communication.

- > **"Some"** → Used in affirmative sentences and offers/requests.
 - » I have some friends → tengo amigos / tengo algunos amigos
 - » Would you like some tea? → ¿te apetece un poco de té? / ¿Quieres té?
- > **"Any"** → Used in negative sentences and questions.
 - » I don't have any money → no tengo dinero
 - » There isn't any milk → no hay nada de leche
 - » Do you have any money? → ¿tienes dinero?
 - » Do you have any questions? → ¿tienes alguna pregunta?

RECUERDA

La **diferencia principal** entre «some» y «any» radica en **su uso en distintos tipos de oraciones**.

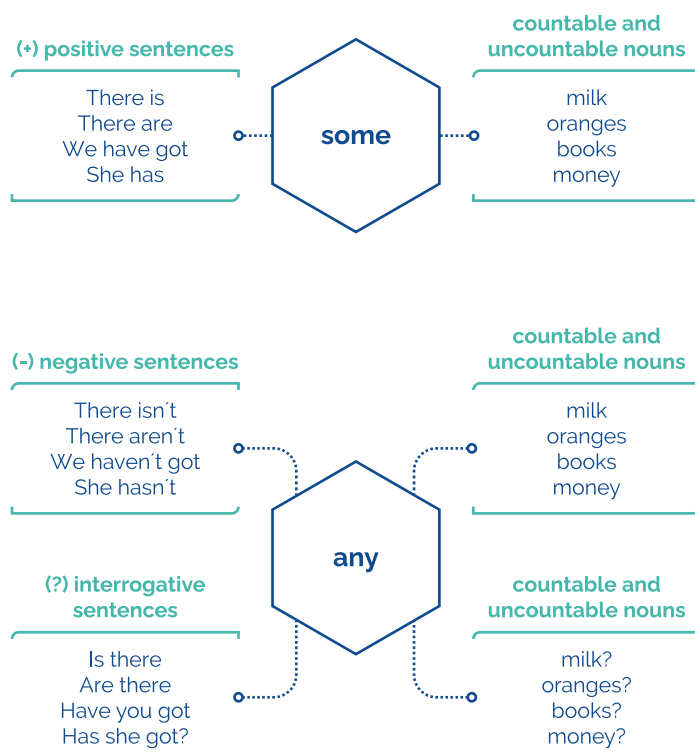
Generalmente, «some» **se emplea en oraciones afirmativas** y para hacer ofrecimientos o **peticiones**, mientras que «any» **se usa en oraciones negativas e interrogativas**.

More examples with there is / there are / a / an / some / any to make it clear.

- > **Oraciones afirmativas (usamos some)**
 - » There is some milk in the fridge. (Hay algo de leche en la nevera.)
 - » There are some apples on the table. (Hay algunas manzanas en la mesa.)
- > **Oraciones negativas (usamos any)**
 - » There isn't any sugar left. (No queda nada de azúcar.)
 - » There aren't any chairs in the room. (No hay sillas en la habitación.)
- > **Oraciones interrogativas**
 - » Is there any coffee in the kitchen? (¿Hay café en la cocina?)
 - » Are there any books on the shelf? (¿Hay libros en la estantería?)
- > **Reglas clave:**
 - » Some en afirmativas.
 - » Any en negativas e interrogativas.



Look at this picture to help you





2.2.4. Use of some / any / no

As we have just studied, the words **some**, and **any** are quantifiers used to refer to an indefinite quantity of something. We will add now the quantifier **no**.

Use of No

- > **Meaning:** none, nothing, no one.
- > **Used in:**
 - » **Negative sentences with a positive verb:** oraciones con valor negativo y verbo positivo.
 - + There is no sugar in the house.
 - + I have no idea
 - + She has no friends in this city



RECUERDA

La doble negación en inglés es incorrecta:

- + I don't have no money. ✗
- + I don't have any money. → No tengo dinero. ✓
- + I have no money. → No tengo dinero. ✓

Find below a summary table to help you:

Quantifier	Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
Some	I have some apples. ✓ Tengo (algunas) manzanas.	Not used ✗	Would you like some tea? ✓ ¿Te gustaria/apetece un poco de té?
Any	Take any book. ✓ Coge cualquier libro.	I don't have any money. ✓ No tengo dinero.	Do you have any questions? ✓ ¿Tienes alguna pregunta?
No	I have no time. ✓ No tengo tiempo (verbo afirmativo con significado negativo)	Not used ✗ I don't have no money.	Not used ✗



2.2.5. The compounds of some / any / no

These compounds are used to talk about **people, things, or places** in an indefinite way. Look at the table below:

Category	With some	With any	With no
People (personas)	someone / somebody (alguien)	anyone / anybody (cualquiera, alguien, en oraciones negativas e interrogativas)	no one / nobody (nadie, en oraciones con el verbo en afirmativo)
Things (cosas)	something (algo)	anything (cualquier cosa, algo, en oraciones negativas e interrogativas)	nothing (nada, en oraciones con el verbo en afirmativo)
Places (lugares)	somewhere (en algún lugar)	anywhere (en cualquier lugar, en oraciones negativas e interrogativas)	nowhere (en ningún lugar, en oraciones con el verbo en afirmativo)



RECUERDA

La doble negación en inglés es incorrecto:

- + I don't want to go nowhere. ✗
- + I don't want to go anywhere. → No quiero ir a ningún sitio. ✓
- + I want to go nowhere. → No quiero ir a ningún sitio. ✓

Here you have some examples of compounds to help you:

> SOME:

- » Would you like something to eat? → ¿te gustaría/apetece algo de comer?
- » There is someone at the door → hay alguien en la puerta.
- » Let's go somewhere nice → vayamos a algún sitio bonito.

> ANY:

- » I don't know anyone here → no conozco a nadie aquí
- » Do you need anything? ¿necesitas algo?
- » You can sit anywhere → puedes sentarte en cualquier lugar

> NO:

- » Nobody called me → no me llamó nadie
- » There is nothing in the fridge → no hay nada en la nevera.
- » She went nowhere last week → No fue a ningún sitio la semana pasada.



2.3.

Wh- questions

2.3.1. Definition

Wh- questions are questions that start with a question word beginning with "Wh." They are used to ask for specific information, not just "yes" or "no" answers. Let's see some examples:

- > Do you like reading?
 - » Yes, I do. / No, I don't. ✓
- > What do you like reading?
 - » Yes, I do. / No, I don't. ✗

No se puede contestar con sí o no, la respuesta requiere más información.

- > What do you like reading?
 - » I like mystery books. ✓

2.3.2. Wh- questions.

Most common word list and their uses

Wh- Word	Meaning	Use	Example
What	Qué	Asking about things or information	What is your name?
Where	Dónde	Asking about places	Where do you live?
When	Cuándo	Asking about time	When is your birthday?
Who	Quién	Asking about people (es el sujeto de la oración interrogativa)	Who is your best friend?
Why	Por qué	Asking about the reason for something	Why are you late?
How much	Cuánto	Asking about uncountable quantities (para cantidades incontables)	How much water do you drink?
How many	Cuántos	Asking about countable quantities (para cantidades contables)	How many books do you have?
How often	Con qué frecuencia	Asking about frequency	How often does she travel to London?



2.3.3. Question structure

The structure of a Wh- question usually follows this pattern:

- > **Wh- word + auxiliary verb + subject + main verb + complement?**
 - » Where do you work? → ¿Dónde trabajas?
 - » What does Susan want? → ¿Qué quiere Susan?
- > **Wh- word + verb TO BE + subject + complement?**
 - » Why is he so sad? → ¿Por qué está tan triste?
 - » How much money is there? → ¿Cuánto dinero hay?
- > **If "Wh-" is the subject of the sentence, we don't use an auxiliary verb:**
 - » Who calls you? → ¿Quién te llama? ✓
 - » ~~Who do call you?~~ ✗



RECUERDA

Las **WH- questions** son preguntas que comienzan con una palabra interrogativa que empieza con **wh-** (excepto "how"). Se usan para las preguntas que buscan obtener más información que simplemente sí o no como respuesta.

El orden de las palabras de este tipo de preguntas varía según el verbo principal sea el verbo TO BE o no.

+ Verbo TO BE:

- > Where is she? ✓
- > ~~Where does she is?~~ ✗

+ Otro verbo:

Do / does Presente simple:

- > Where does she live? → ¿Dónde vive?
- > What do you think? → ¿Qué crees?

Did Pasado simple:

- > When did she come? → ¿Cuándo vino ella?
- > When did you come? → ¿Cuándo viniste?





2.4.

Pronouns and possessive forms

Pronouns are words that replace nouns to avoid repetition. They can be **subject pronouns** (I, you, he, she, it, we, they) or **object pronouns** (me, you, him, her, it, us, them).

Possessive forms indicate ownership or relationship. There are **possessive adjectives** (my, your, his, her, its, our, their), which are used before a noun (e.g., *This is my book*), and **possessive pronouns** (mine, yours, his, hers, its, ours, theirs), which replace a noun (e.g., *This book is mine*).

Let's see this table to compare all of them

Pronouns and Possessive Forms			
Subject pronouns	Object pronouns	Possessive adjectives	Possessive pronouns
I	me	my	mine
You	you	your	yours
He	him	his	his
She	her	her	hers
It	it	its	its
We	us	our	ours
You	you	your	yours
They	them	their	theirs

Let's see now some examples to make it clear for you:

- > "He (subject pronoun) sent me (object pronoun) several letters"
- > "Él (pronombre sujeto) me (pronombre objeto) envió varias cartas"
- > "Is this your laptop? No, it isn't. I think it is hers"
 - » "¿Este es tu (adjetivo posesivo) ordenador? No, creo que es suyo (pronombre posesivo, de ella en este caso)"

Let's check some wrong examples now.

- > This is mine laptop →
This is my laptop / This laptop is mine.
- > Este es mio ordenador →
Este es mi ordenador / Este ordenador es mío.

RECUERDA

Utiliza los pronombres sujetos (subject pronouns) para indicar quién o qué realiza la acción del verbo.

- + She speaks French. (Ella habla francés) ✓
- + Her speaks French: (Su, de ella, habla francés) X

Utiliza los pronombres objetos (object pronouns) para indicar quién o qué recibe la acción del verbo.

- + She speaks French with me. (Ella habla francés conmigo) ✓
- + Her speaks French with I (Ella habla francés con yo) X

Utiliza los adjetivos posesivos (possessive adjective) delante siempre de un sustantivo para indicar posesión.

- + They have bought our car. (Ellos han comprado nuestro coche) ✓
- + They have bought we car. (Ellos han comprador nosotros coche) X

Utiliza los pronombres posesivos (possessive pronouns) para indicar posesión sin necesidad de repetir el sustantivo. Reemplazan a un sustantivo que ya ha sido mencionado previamente.

- + I love their car. I love theirs. (Me encanta su coche, de ellos. Me encanta el suyo) ✓
- + I love theirs cars. I love they. (Me encanta suyo coche, de ellos. Me encanta ellos) X



2.5.

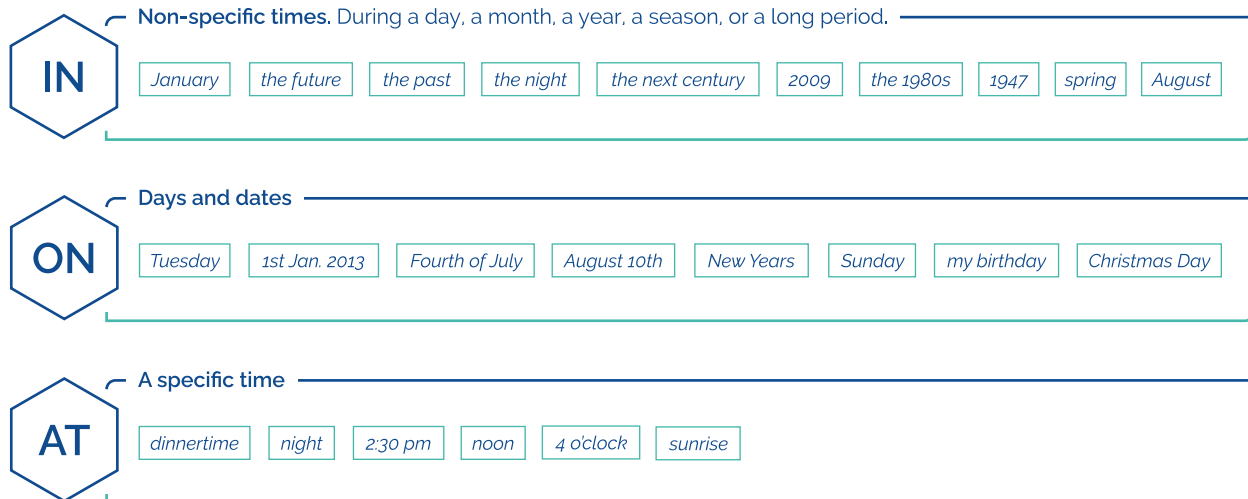
Prepositions of time

Prepositions of time are used to indicate when something happens. The main prepositions of time are:

Prepositions of time				
IN				
Months	Seasons	Years	Long periods	Parts of the day
In june	in winter	in 2021	in the 90s in the 18th century	in the morning in the afternoon in the evening
AT				
Times of day	Mealtimes	Holidays	Expressions	
at midnight at noon at 12 o'clock	at lunchtime at dinnertime	at christmas at the weekend at easter	at present at the moment at night	
ON				
Days	Dates		Last/next	
on monday on my birthday on halloween on christmas day	on 16 th april		don't need any preposition last week next tuesday	

Here you have a picture to help you:

Non-specific



Specific



2.6.

Connectors

Connectors are words or phrases used to link ideas in a conversation. They help organize speech, making it clearer, more fluent, and easier to understand. Connectors can show addition (*also, moreover*), contrast (*but, however*), cause and effect (*because, so*), examples (*for example*), sequence (*first, then*), opinion (*in my opinion*), and conclusion (*to sum up*). Using them correctly improves communication and makes speech sound more natural.

Here is a list of the main connectors in English, along with their explanation and examples.

Addition (Añadir información)

- > **Also → También** (es neutral, siempre va delante del verbo principal o después del verbo to be).
 - » I like traveling. I also enjoy learning new languages.
 - » Peter speaks three different languages. He is also very talented with the piano.
- > **Besides → Además** (es más informal).
 - » I don't want to go out. Besides, it's raining.
- > **Moreover → Además** (es más formal)
 - » He is very intelligent. Moreover, he is hardworking.

Contrast (Contraste)

- > **But → Pero**
 - » I like coffee, but I prefer tea.
- > **However → Sin embargo** (se usa para conectar dos oraciones independientes).
 - » The exam was difficult. However, I managed to pass it.
- > **Although → Aunque** (se usa dentro de la misma oración para contrastar ideas).
 - » Although it was cold, we went for a walk.
- > **On the one hand... on the other hand → Por un lado... por otro.**
 - » On the one hand, working from home is very convenient. On the other hand, it can be quite lonely.





Cause and Effect (Causa y consecuencia)

- > **Because → Porque.**
 - » I stayed at home because I was tired.
- > **So → Así que.**
 - » It was late, so we went home.
- > **Therefore → Por lo tanto.**
 - » She didn't study. Therefore, she failed the exam.

Giving Examples (Dar ejemplos)

- > **For example → Por ejemplo.**
 - » I love tropical fruits, for example, mangoes and pineapples.
- > **For instance → Por ejemplo (más formal).**
 - » There are many European countries, for instance, Spain and Italy.

Sequencing (Ordenar ideas)

- > **First, firstly → Antes que nada, en primer lugar.**
 - » First, we need to buy the ingredients.
- > **Then → Luego.**
 - » We went to the cinema. Then, we had dinner.
- > **After that → Después de eso.**
 - » She finished her work. After that, she went to bed.
- > **Finally → Finalmente.**
 - » Finally, we arrived at the hotel.

Opinion (Expresar opinión)

- > **In my opinion → En mi opinión.**
 - » In my opinion, this movie is quite good.
- > **From my point of view → Desde mi punto de vista.**
 - » From my point of view, learning a second language is essential.
- > **I think that → Creo que.**
 - » I think that English is very important.
- > **Personally, I believe → Personalmente, creo.**
 - » Personally, I believe that travelling is essential.



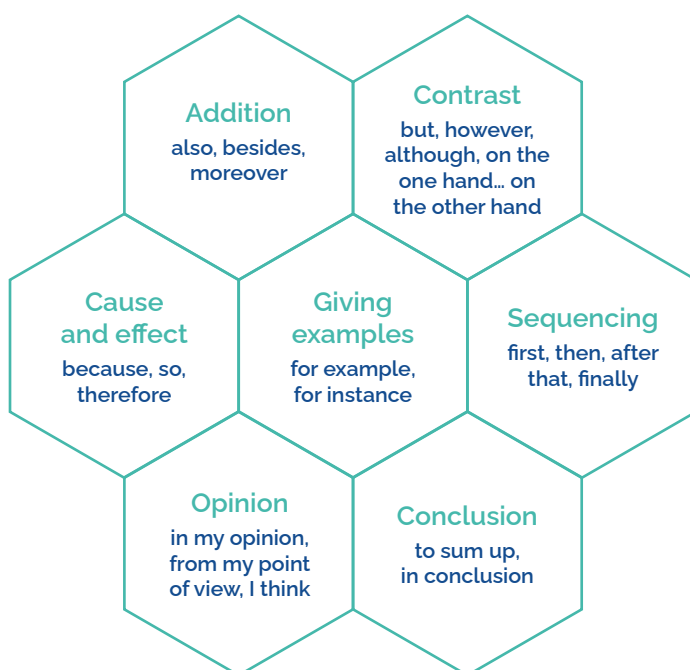
Conclusion (Conclusión)

- > To sum up → Para resumir.
 - » To sum up, we had an amazing trip.
- > In conclusion → En conclusión.
 - » In conclusion, learning English is very useful.



RECUERDA

Los conectores son palabras o frases que ayudan a estructurar y conectar ideas en una conversación. Su uso es clave para hablar de manera más clara, fluida y organizada en inglés. En cada grupo tienes varias opciones que puedes alternar para no repetir siempre el mismo conector.





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